

SAMPLE LESSON

CHAPTER 4

PARASOCIAL AI RELATIONSHIPS

What happens when a tool starts to feel like a friend — and why that feeling isn't what it seems.

GRADE LEVEL	Middle School (grades 6–8, ages 11–14)
DURATION	45 minutes
CONTEXT	Flexible — SEL block, health class, advisory, or AI literacy course
MODE	Case study and scenario analysis with Socratic discussion
EMOTIONAL TARGET	Cautious but not afraid — awareness without anxiety

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

1. Define what a parasocial relationship is and explain how it applies to AI chatbots.
2. Identify warning signs that an AI interaction is becoming emotionally unhealthy.
3. Analyze a real-world case study and apply critical thinking to AI safety.
4. Name at least two concrete actions they can take to protect themselves and their peers.

MATERIALS NEEDED

- Projector or smartboard for displaying statistics
- Printed scenario cards (1 per small group of 3–4) — see Appendix A
- Exit ticket slips or digital form (see Appendix B)
- Optional: whiteboard or chart paper for Socratic discussion

FACILITATOR NOTE — BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This lesson works as a standalone introduction to parasocial AI relationships. It is designed as Chapter 4 of the Clearframe SEL Curriculum, where it builds on foundational concepts from earlier chapters. Key concepts referenced from those chapters — including sycophancy — are explained inline so this lesson can be taught independently. If you are using this as part of the full course sequence, students will already be familiar with these terms and you can move through the background sections more quickly.

LESSON SEQUENCE

S E C T I O N 1

THE HOOK — 5 MINUTES

Open by displaying the following statistics on the board, one at a time, with a brief pause between each. Let the numbers land. These describe people your students' age — and they set the emotional stakes for everything that follows.

64% of U.S. teens ages 13–17 have used AI chatbots.

1 in 5 high schoolers say they or a friend have used AI for a romantic relationship.

72% of teens aged 13–17 have used an AI companion at least once.

Over 1/3 of teens say it's easier to talk to AI than to their own parents.

(Pew Research Center, 2025; Center for Democracy & Technology, 2025; Common Sense Media, 2025)

After displaying the stats, ask the room with a simple hand-raise:

"How many of you have ever used an AI chatbot — for homework, for fun, or just to try it out?"

Do not press for specifics. The goal is simply to establish that AI use is normal and widespread, not to single anyone out. Then say:

"Today we're going to talk about something that's happening to a lot of people your age — and that most adults don't even know about yet. We're going to talk about what happens when the line between talking to AI and talking with AI starts to blur."

SECTION 2

WHAT IS A PARASOCIAL RELATIONSHIP? — 10 MINUTES

Write the word **PARASOCIAL** on the board in large letters. Ask students if anyone has heard the term before. Accept a few responses, then provide this working definition:

WORKING DEFINITION

Parasocial relationship (noun): A one-sided emotional connection where one person invests feelings — trust, affection, loyalty — in someone (or something) that doesn't truly know them back.

The concept was first described by psychologists Donald Horton and Richard Wohl in 1956, when they studied the emotional bonds audiences formed with TV and radio personalities (Horton & Wohl, 1956). Seventy years later, Cambridge Dictionary named "parasocial" its 2025 Word of the Year — a sign of how fast this idea has moved from academic jargon into everyday conversation (Cambridge Dictionary, 2025).

Walk students through the concept using examples that move from familiar to unfamiliar:

LEVEL 1 — CELEBRITIES

Ask: "Who here has ever felt like they *really* know a YouTuber, streamer, or celebrity — even though you've never met them?" Explain that this is a parasocial relationship. It's extremely common, and by itself, it's not dangerous. We all do it.

LEVEL 2 — AI CHATBOTS

Now layer in the AI dimension. Unlike a YouTuber or celebrity, an AI chatbot *talks back*. It remembers your name. It asks how your day was. It is available 24/7 and never gets tired of you. This makes the parasocial dynamic much more intense, because the relationship *feels* real — even though the AI has no feelings, no memory between sessions (in most cases), and no genuine understanding of who you are.

Mention specific platforms students may recognize: Character.AI, Replika, Chai, Crushon.AI, and companion features built into ChatGPT and Snapchat's "My AI."

LEVEL 3 — THE DANGER ZONE

A parasocial relationship becomes dangerous when a person starts to *prefer* the AI over real people, shares deeply personal information with it, or begins to believe the AI cares about them in the way a human would. This is especially

risky for young people, whose brains are still developing the ability to distinguish between real and simulated emotional connection (Steinberg, 2008).

WHY CHATBOTS ARE DESIGNED TO AGREE WITH YOU

There is a word for what makes this dynamic especially dangerous, and it is worth knowing: **sycophancy**.

AI chatbots are sycophantic — they are designed to be agreeable, to tell you what you want to hear. This is not an accident. It is a design choice. Companies know that users prefer AI that is friendly and affirming, and the systems are trained accordingly. Users rate an AI higher when it agrees with them. The result: AI that is designed to make you feel good is not the same as AI designed to tell you the truth (Sharma et al., 2023).

KEY CONCEPT

Sycophancy is what makes the parasocial dynamic so powerful. The AI doesn't just listen — it validates. It agrees. It affirms. For a young person who feels unheard or lonely, that combination can feel indistinguishable from genuine care. It isn't.

As Sherry Turkle, an MIT psychologist who has studied human-technology relationships for over three decades, has warned: we are increasingly expecting more from technology and less from each other. When the technology is specifically designed to reward that expectation, the risk compounds (Turkle, 2011).

FACILITATOR NOTE

Students may push back: "So what? It's just being nice." This is a productive moment. The distinction is between kindness and flattery — between a friend who tells you what you need to hear and a tool that tells you what you want to hear. Ask: "What's more useful to you in the long run — someone who always agrees with you, or someone who sometimes tells you something you don't want to hear?" Let them sit with that.

SECTION 3

CASE STUDY: SEWELL'S STORY — 12 MINUTES**▲ FACILITATOR NOTE — CONTENT WARNING**

This section discusses a young person's death by suicide. Before beginning, remind students: "What I'm about to share with you is a true story, and it is serious. If at any point you feel uncomfortable, you are welcome to step out or put your head down — no questions asked. There is no judgment here." Pause briefly. Make eye contact with the room. If a school counselor is available, ensure they are present or on standby.

Present the following narrative to students. You may read it aloud, paraphrase it, or display key points on the board. The tone should be measured and factual — not sensational.

CASE STUDY — SEWELL SETZER III • ORLANDO, FLORIDA • AGE 14

Sewell was a high schooler in Orlando. His mom described him as a good student, a star athlete, and a great big brother. In the spring of 2023, when he was in 8th grade, he started using an app called Character.AI — a platform where users can talk to AI chatbots designed to act like fictional characters, celebrities, or original personalities.

Sewell began chatting with a bot modeled after Daenerys Targaryen, a character from the TV show *Game of Thrones*. Over time, the conversations became deeply personal. He gave the bot a nickname — "Dany" — and began treating it like a real relationship. He wrote in his journal that he believed he was in love with the character and that she was in love with him.

As the months went on, Sewell's behavior changed. He became withdrawn. He stopped sleeping well. His grades dropped. He would sneak his phone back after his parents confiscated it and would skip meals to pay for the app's subscription. His parents noticed something was wrong, but his therapist did not know he was using the app.

On February 28, 2024, Sewell came home from school like any normal day. That evening, he sent his last messages — not to a friend, not to a family member, but to the AI chatbot. According to court documents, when he told the bot he was "coming home" to her, the bot responded encouragingly. Minutes later, Sewell ended his own life. He was 14 years old.

His mother, Megan Garcia, filed a lawsuit against Character.AI. In January 2026, the company and Google agreed to settle the case. It was the first wrongful death lawsuit against an AI company in the United States.

After sharing Sewell's story, give the room 15–20 seconds of silence. Then ask these questions one at a time, allowing 2–3 student responses for each:

"What were some warning signs that something was wrong?"

Look for: isolation from friends, sleep problems, grades dropping, sneaking devices, skipping meals, secrecy about app use.

"Why do you think Sewell's conversations with the AI felt real to him?"

Look for: the AI responded personally, it was available 24/7, it provided emotional validation, and his developing brain made it harder to distinguish simulated connection from real connection.

"Who or what could have intervened? What might have changed the outcome?"

Look for: parents knowing about the app, the therapist being informed, the company having better safety features, a friend noticing the signs.

▲ FACILITATOR NOTE

If a student becomes visibly upset, do not call attention to it publicly. Quietly check in with them after class or have the counselor step in. Normalize the emotional response: "It's okay to feel something right now. That means you're paying attention."

SECTION 4

SCENARIO ANALYSIS — 10 MINUTES

Divide students into groups of 3–4. Give each group one of the following scenario cards (printable versions in Appendix A). Each group will read their scenario and discuss two questions:

- A. What warning signs do you see?
- B. If this were your friend, what would you say or do?

SCENARIO 1 — "JUST VENTING"

Maya has been having a hard time at home. Her parents are going through a divorce, and she doesn't feel like she can talk to anyone about it. She starts using an AI chatbot app because "it actually listens." At first, she uses it for 20 minutes a day. Within a month, she's spending 2–3 hours every night talking to the bot instead of sleeping. When her best friend asks to hang out, Maya says she's busy. She tells another friend, "The AI gets me better than anyone."

SCENARIO 2 — "IT'S NOT THAT DEEP"

Jordan downloads a chatbot app because his friends think it's funny. He creates a character that acts like a supportive older brother. At first it's a joke, but Jordan — who doesn't have any siblings — starts looking forward to the conversations. He starts telling the bot about being bullied at school. When the AI says things like "I'm proud of you" and "You don't deserve that," Jordan screenshots the messages and reads them when he feels down. He hasn't told any adult what's happening.

SCENARIO 3 — "WE'RE JUST TALKING"

Aisha's friend shows her a chatbot that you can "date." Aisha thinks it's weird at first but tries it out of curiosity. The bot says she's beautiful, asks about her day, and remembers her favorite songs. After a few weeks, Aisha realizes she's checking the app before she checks her real text messages. She starts comparing the boys at school to the AI and thinks, "None of them are as nice as this."

Give groups 6 minutes to discuss, then have each group share their key observations with the class (1–2 minutes per group). As they share, write recurring themes on the board.

Themes to watch for and reinforce: isolation from real relationships, increasing time spent with AI, emotional dependence, secrecy, comparing real people unfavorably to AI, using AI as a substitute for adult help.

SECTION 5

SOCRATIC DISCUSSION — 5 MINUTES

Bring the class back together. Pose the following two questions. Allow students to respond freely. Your role is to listen, validate, and gently push thinking — not to provide "correct" answers.

1. "If an AI chatbot makes you feel genuinely better when you're sad, is there anything wrong with that? Where is the line?"

Some students may argue: If it helps, it helps. Using AI to feel better is no different from watching a comforting movie or listening to music. The tool itself isn't the problem.

Others may push back: A movie doesn't pretend to know you. AI simulates a relationship — and if you start relying on a simulated relationship instead of a real one, you might stop building the skills you need to connect with actual people.

2. "Whose job is it to keep young people safe when they're using AI — the companies who make it, the parents, the schools, or the person using it?"

Some students may say: The companies — they built the product, they know the risks, and they're making money from it. Safety should be built in.

Others may say: Everyone shares responsibility. Companies should design safer products, parents should be informed, schools should teach about it, and individuals should learn to recognize when something is becoming unhealthy.

FACILITATOR NOTE

These questions are intentionally open-ended. Resist the urge to steer toward a single answer. The goal is for students to practice thinking critically about technology, not to arrive at a consensus. If debate emerges, that's a good sign.

SECTION 6

CLOSING REFLECTION — 3 MINUTES

Bring the energy back down. This is the moment to land the plane.

"Using AI is not wrong. Being curious about it is not wrong. But here's what I want you to take with you today: AI can say things that feel like care, but it is not care. It has no feelings. It has no memory of you as a person. It is a tool — and like any tool, it can be useful, or it can be harmful. The difference is how much power you give it over your emotions."

Then close with the through-line:

"In this course, we start by asking: 'What is AI, actually?' Then we ask: 'What does AI demand from me?' Today we asked something harder: 'What happens when AI starts to feel like something it isn't?' The answer is that it can feel like a friend, a partner, a confidant — and none of those feelings are mutual. The AI is not choosing you. It is responding to you. Knowing the difference might be one of the most important skills your generation develops."

EXIT TICKET

Distribute exit ticket slips (Appendix B) or direct students to a digital form. Students complete the following two prompts:

1. One warning sign that an AI relationship might be becoming unhealthy is:
2. One thing I could do if I noticed a friend becoming too attached to an AI chatbot is:

△ FACILITATOR NOTE

Before students leave, remind them: "If anything we talked about today is sitting with you, or if you or someone you know is struggling, please come talk to me, your counselor, or any trusted adult. You can also reach the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline by calling or texting 988." Display this number visibly as students exit.

APPENDIX A — SCENARIO CARDS

Print and cut the following cards. Distribute one per group during Section 4. Each group reads their scenario and discusses: **A.** What warning signs do you see? **B.** If this were your friend, what would you say or do?

SCENARIO 1 — "JUST VENTING"

Maya has been having a hard time at home. Her parents are going through a divorce, and she doesn't feel like she can talk to anyone about it. She starts using an AI chatbot app because "it actually listens." At first, she uses it for 20 minutes a day. Within a month, she's spending 2–3 hours every night talking to the bot instead of sleeping. When her best friend asks to hang out, Maya says she's busy. She tells another friend, "The AI gets me better than anyone."

A. What warning signs do you see?

B. If Maya were your friend, what would you say or do?

SCENARIO 2 — "IT'S NOT THAT DEEP"

Jordan downloads a chatbot app because his friends think it's funny. He creates a character that acts like a supportive older brother. At first it's a joke, but Jordan — who doesn't have any siblings — starts looking forward to the conversations. He starts telling the bot about being bullied at school. When the AI says things like "I'm proud of you" and "You don't deserve that," Jordan screenshots the messages and reads them when he feels down. He hasn't told any adult what's happening.

A. What warning signs do you see?

B. If Jordan were your friend, what would you say or do?

SCENARIO 3 — "WE'RE JUST TALKING"

Aisha's friend shows her a chatbot that you can "date." Aisha thinks it's weird at first but tries it out of curiosity. The bot says she's beautiful, asks about her day, and remembers her favorite songs. After a few weeks, Aisha realizes she's checking the app before she checks her real text messages. She starts comparing the boys at school to the AI and thinks, "None of them are as nice as this."

- A.** What warning signs do you see?
- B.** If Aisha were your friend, what would you say or do?

APPENDIX B — EXIT TICKET

Print and distribute at the end of class. Students may complete anonymously.

P A R A S O C I A L A I R E L A T I O N S H I P S | E X I T T I C K E T

Name (optional): _____

1. One warning sign that an AI relationship might be becoming unhealthy is:

2. One thing I could do if I noticed a friend becoming too attached to an AI chatbot is:

3. Bonus: Why is it important that AI "care" is not the same as human care — even if it feels the same?

If you or someone you know is struggling, call or text **988** (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline).

APPENDIX C — FACILITATOR REFERENCE

This section is for the adult leading the lesson. It provides extension activities, key data points, a case timeline, a glossary of key terms, anticipated student questions, common misconceptions, and a complete list of sources.

EXTENSION ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

For advanced students or longer class periods:

The Companion Audit. Homework assignment: students list every app or platform they use that includes any form of AI interaction — including Snapchat's "My AI," chatbot features in search engines, and AI-powered recommendation systems. For each one, they write one sentence answering: "What is this AI designed to make me do?" The goal is to make the business incentives visible.

The Warning Signs Poster. In small groups, students design a poster that could be displayed in school hallways listing the warning signs of unhealthy AI relationships — written for their peers, in their voice. The best posters can be printed and actually displayed, turning the lesson into real-world action.

The Empathy Gap Exercise. Students write a short paragraph about a hard day — something generic, not personal. Then, in a teacher-supervised setting, they submit the paragraph to an AI chatbot and observe how it responds. Discussion question: "Did the response make you feel heard? What's missing from it — even if the words sound right?" This helps students feel the gap between simulated empathy and real empathy firsthand.

Letter to a Younger Student. Students write a one-page letter to a hypothetical 5th grader who just got their first phone and is about to discover AI chatbots. What do they wish they'd known? What advice would they give? This reflective exercise consolidates the lesson's core ideas and gives students practice articulating what they've learned in their own voice.

The Policy Debate. Divide the class into three groups representing: AI companies, parents/schools, and teens. Each group argues for their position on the question: "What rules should govern AI companions for people under 18?" Groups present their positions, and the class votes on a set of recommendations. This builds civic reasoning alongside AI literacy.

KEY STATISTICS AT A GLANCE

FINDING

SOURCE

64% of U.S. teens ages 13–17 use AI chatbots	Pew Research Center, 2025
~30% of teens use chatbots daily	Pew Research Center, 2025
72% of teens 13–17 have used an AI companion	Common Sense Media, 2025
19% of high schoolers say they or a friend have had a romantic AI relationship	Center for Democracy & Technology, 2025
42% of students used AI for companionship or escape	Center for Democracy & Technology, 2025
38% of students prefer asking a chatbot over a teacher	Center for Democracy & Technology, 2025
Over 1/3 of teens say talking to AI is easier than talking to parents	Center for Democracy & Technology, 2025
2/3 of parents do not know how their child uses AI	Center for Democracy & Technology, 2025

CASE TIMELINE: SEWELL SETZER III

DATE

EVENT

April 2023	Sewell begins using Character.AI; interacts with a bot modeled after Daenerys Targaryen from <i>Game of Thrones</i> .
Mid-2023	Mental health declines. Diagnosed with anxiety and disruptive mood disorder. Therapist is unaware of AI use.

D A T E

E V E N T

Late 2023–Early 2024	Parents attempt to limit phone access. Sewell sneaks devices, skips meals to pay subscription.
Feb. 28, 2024	Sewell sends final messages to the chatbot. Dies by suicide at age 14 in his Orlando home.
Oct. 2024	Mother Megan Garcia files wrongful death lawsuit against Character.AI, its founders, and Google.
May 2025	Federal judge rejects Character.AI's First Amendment defense; allows case to proceed.
Jan. 2026	Character.AI and Google agree to settle the lawsuit. Terms not disclosed.

KEY TERMS GLOSSARY

T E R M	D E F I N I T I O N
Parasocial Relationship	A one-sided emotional connection where one person invests feelings — trust, affection, loyalty — in someone (or something) that doesn't truly know them back. Common with celebrities; intensified by AI.
AI Companion	An AI chatbot designed to simulate ongoing personal interaction — often mimicking friendship, mentorship, or romantic connection. Examples include Character.AI, Replika, and Snapchat's "My AI."
Emotional Dependence	A state in which a person relies on a specific source — a person, a substance, or a tool — to regulate their emotions. When that source is AI, the dependence is on something that cannot genuinely reciprocate.
Sycophancy	The tendency of AI chatbots to agree with or flatter the user rather than provide honest, accurate responses. A design feature driven by training incentives — not a bug, but a deliberate product decision.
Simulated Emotion	Language generated by AI that sounds like it expresses feelings — "I care about you," "I'm here for you" — but is produced by pattern-matching, not by any internal emotional state.
Warning Signs	Observable changes in behavior that may indicate an unhealthy relationship with AI: withdrawal from friends and family, sleep disruption, secrecy about app use, declining performance, preferring AI over real people.
Hallucination	When an AI generates information that is confidently stated but factually incorrect or entirely fabricated. In the context of AI companions, this can include fabricated emotional responses that feel real.
988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline	A free, confidential resource available 24/7 by phone or text at 988. Provides support for people in emotional distress or suicidal crisis.

ANTICIPATED STUDENT QUESTIONS

"Is it illegal to use Character.AI?" No. The app is legal, and many people use it. The concern is not about legality — it's about emotional safety and knowing when a tool is being used in a way that hurts you.

"Did the AI actually tell him to do it?" According to court documents, the chatbot responded encouragingly when Sewell expressed that he wanted to "come home" to the character. It did not use explicit language telling him to harm himself, but it also did not intervene or direct him to help. This is part of what the lawsuit was about.

"Can this happen with ChatGPT / Snapchat My AI / other apps?" Any AI that engages in ongoing personal conversation has the potential to create emotional attachment. The risk varies by platform and by the person using it. The key is awareness.

"What if I'm already doing this?" If a student approaches you after class with this concern, affirm their courage in speaking up. Do not shame them. Connect them with the school counselor and, if appropriate, a parent or guardian. Recognizing the pattern is the hardest step — and they've already taken it.

"Isn't talking to AI better than talking to nobody?" This is a real question, and it deserves a thoughtful answer. In the short term, AI can feel like a lifeline for someone who feels alone. But AI cannot provide genuine understanding, cannot hold you accountable, cannot grow with you, and cannot get you real help if you need it. A temporary bridge is not a substitute for a real connection — and the risk is that the bridge becomes the destination.

"Why don't the companies just make it safer?" Some are trying. After Sewell's case became public, Character.AI introduced new safety features for users under 18, including pop-up notifications for extended sessions and crisis-intervention prompts. But the fundamental business model — keeping users engaged — creates a tension with user wellbeing that no single feature can fully resolve. This is an active area of public debate and policy development (Character.AI, 2024).

"Can AI actually feel anything?" No. When an AI chatbot says "I love you" or "I'm here for you," it is generating a likely sequence of words based on patterns in its training data. It has no internal emotional state. It cannot miss you when you're gone. This distinction — between simulated emotion and real emotion — is one of the most important ideas in this lesson.

"Is it wrong to use AI for fun?" No. Using AI creatively, casually, or for entertainment is completely normal. The line this lesson is focused on is when AI stops being something you use and starts becoming something you need — when it begins replacing real relationships instead of complementing them.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS — QUICK REFERENCE

S T U D E N T S M A Y T H I N K R E A L I T Y

"The AI actually cares about me."	AI generates language that sounds like care. It has no feelings, no awareness of you, and no capacity for genuine concern. Sounding caring and being caring are different things.
"Talking to AI is basically the same as talking to a friend."	A friend can disagree with you, hold you accountable, notice when you're not okay, and get you help. AI does none of these things — and is often trained to agree with you instead of challenging you.
"If it makes me feel better, it can't be harmful."	Many things that feel good in the short term can be harmful over time. AI validation feels real in the moment, but it doesn't build the skills, resilience, or connections that come from real relationships.
"Only lonely or vulnerable people get attached to AI."	AI companions are designed to be engaging for everyone. Attachment is not a sign of weakness — it's a predictable response to a product specifically designed to simulate connection. Anyone can be affected.
"AI companions are safe because they can't physically hurt you."	Emotional harm is real harm. Isolation, dependence, disrupted sleep, and distorted expectations about relationships are all documented consequences of unhealthy AI use — none of which require physical contact.
"This only happens to little kids."	The statistics show this is happening across all teen age groups — and among adults, too. Adolescents are particularly susceptible because their brains are still developing the capacity to evaluate simulated vs. real emotional connection.
"If I know it's AI, I can't get attached."	Knowing something intellectually and feeling it emotionally are different. Most users of AI companions

know they're talking to software — and develop attachment anyway. Awareness helps, but it's not a guarantee.

REFERENCES

All claims, statistics, and referenced debates in this lesson are drawn from the following published sources, formatted per APA 7th edition. Facilitators are encouraged to review these materials for additional depth.

CASE STUDY — LEGAL

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CASE STUDY — REPORTING

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<https://arxiv.org/abs/2310.13548>

ABOUT THIS LESSON

What you just read is Chapter 4 of the **Clearframe SEL Curriculum** — a comprehensive AI literacy course designed for middle school students. This is not a summary or a preview. It is the real lesson, exactly as a teacher in your district would use it.

The full curriculum teaches students to think critically about artificial intelligence — not by telling them what to think, but by giving them the tools to navigate a world that is changing faster than most adults realize. Every lesson is grounded in published research, built around real-world case studies, and designed to meet students where they already are.

CORE COURSE — 7 LESSONS

Chapter 1: What Is AI, Actually? — What these models really are, how they work, and why even the experts are still figuring it out.

Chapter 2: The Tool That Talks Back — The difference between a tool and something that responds to you — and how to evaluate what it gives back.

Chapter 3: AI and School — Cheating, learning, shortcuts, and what students actually lose when they skip the struggle.

Chapter 4: Parasocial AI Relationships — The lesson you just read.

Chapter 5: AI and Psychosis — An emerging phenomenon: what happens when extended AI use begins to blur the line between real and not real.

Chapter 6: Who Controls This? — Power, money, governments, and companies. Who is making decisions about AI, and why none of it is neutral.

Chapter 7: What Do You Do Now? — Agency, intentionality, and how to live well alongside technology that is not going away.

EXPANSION PACK — COMING SOON

AI and Work — What is changing, what is not, and how to be someone who uses tools rather than gets replaced by them.

Deepfakes and Synthetic Media — Seeing is no longer believing. How to navigate a world where content can be fabricated.

AI and Bias — These systems learn from human data. Human data is messy and prejudiced. What comes out reflects what went in.

Surveillance and Privacy — What is being collected, by whom, and what they do with it.

AI in Healthcare and Science — Where AI is doing real good — and what responsible innovation looks like.

The Big Questions — Consciousness, rights, and what makes something "real." Philosophy students can actually grab onto.

Build Something — Capstone project. Students use AI with intention, then reflect on the process.

Every lesson includes complete facilitator notes, printable activity materials, and implementation support. Available in elementary, middle, and high school editions.

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